

FLOWZEN

Early-Stage Startup Overview for Faculty

Presented by: Piyush — Third-Year Engineering Student

Stage: Customer discovery and problem validation

1. The Idea

Flowzen is an early-stage business workflow automation concept. The goal is to identify repetitive, computer-based work inside businesses and determine which parts can potentially be handled by software, while keeping humans responsible for decisions that require judgment, approval, or accountability.

2. The Problem

Employees in many businesses spend time on repetitive digital tasks such as processing emails, entering or copying data, preparing documents, updating spreadsheets or business systems, sorting routine requests, and coordinating information between teams. These activities may consume time that employees could otherwise spend on work requiring human expertise.

3. Our Approach

We are not starting by building one generic automation product for every company. Different businesses have different processes, systems, rules, and approval requirements. We first understand the company's actual workflow and then identify a suitable automation opportunity.

4. Example Workflow

Example only:

Customer Email → AI Classification → Information Extraction → Business Rules → Human Approval → System Action → Logging

This illustrates the intended architecture; it is not a claim about any current company.

5. Human-in-the-Loop

AI / Software: identify → classify → extract → prepare → recommend

Human: review → approve / edit / reject where appropriate

System: execute approved action → record/log the result

6. What Makes It Different

Our hypothesis is that the starting point should be the **business workflow**, not a predetermined AI feature. We want to avoid forcing every company into the same process. Automation should be designed around the validated workflow and existing business environment.

Core principles: Workflow-Specific • Human-Controlled • System-Integrated • Measurable

7. What We Have Done

- Developed and deployed a project website explaining the concept.
- Organized the project in GitHub and updated the README.
- Prepared customer-discovery and workflow documentation.
- Contacted five companies with personalized research emails.
- Begun customer discovery to learn about real business workflows.

8. Current Status — Important

This is an early-stage idea, not a proven commercial product. We currently do not claim existing customers, production deployments, revenue, guaranteed savings, or measured ROI. Our immediate objective is to validate whether businesses have a sufficiently painful workflow that is worth solving.

9. What We Want to Learn

During a short discovery conversation, we want to understand the workflow, frequency, time involved, people and systems, manual steps, delays or errors, human approval points, and whether improvement can be measured.

10. Validation Roadmap

Idea → Business Outreach → Conversation → Real Workflow → Problem Validation → Prototype → Pilot → Measurement → Case Study → Payment

11. Technical Direction

The final technology stack will depend on the workflow we validate. Potential implementations may involve AI/LLM services, APIs, workflow orchestration, business rules, databases, authentication, ERP/CRM/email integrations, logging, and human approval interfaces. We do not want to choose a complex architecture before understanding the actual requirement.

12. What We Want From Faculty

We would value feedback on:

- Whether the problem is technically and commercially worth exploring.
- Which technical areas we should strengthen as engineering students.
- Whether the workflow-first approach is practical.
- How we should approach companies and pilots responsibly.
- Suggestions for mentors, industry contacts, competitions, or incubation opportunities where appropriate.

13. Next Milestone

One genuine business conversation + one real workflow.

Once we have a real workflow, we can evaluate feasibility, define a small MVP, and decide whether a pilot is justified.

14. Project

Project: Flowzen

Website: ai-automation-startup.vercel.app

Team: Piyush & Harshad